

Oil Tracker: 70% of Pre-War Hormuz Flows Might Become the New 100%

- Spot Brent futures prices slipped below \$80/bbl this week as the US and Iran reached an interim deal that would lift the US blockade and reopen the Strait of Hormuz right after the deal is signed, with the US and Iran reportedly signing the Memorandum of Understanding Wednesday night electronically.
 - The interim deal reportedly includes a waiver for exports of Iranian oil and petrochemicals and for related financial and transportation services, potentially unlocking over 50mb of Iranian oil on water overhang for immediate delivery.
 - We now assume that Persian Gulf exports normalize to pre-war levels by end of July and Persian Gulf crude production recover by October and see risks to the Mideast supply outlook as two-sided, but skewed to the downside on net.
 - We estimate that this normalization in Gulf exports to pre-war levels might be achieved with a 13mb/d increase in Hormuz flows from current levels to around 70% of pre-war levels (Exhibit 3).
 - We estimate average visible Hormuz flows at 1.3mb/d over the 7 days, Gulf of Oman flows (which might be linked to “dark” Hormuz crossings) at 1.6mb/d, and redirections via Yanbu, Fujairah, and Ceyhan at 7.5mb/d.
 - We do not see ship availability as a binding constraint on the recovery of flows as we estimate 860mb of empty tanker capacity within the Strait or within 5 days of navigation (Exhibit 6).
 - However, many shipowners reportedly remain cautious about clear guidelines for transit, and we see shippers’ risk aversion as a potential constraint on the flows, along with Iran’s geopolitical goals over the upcoming 60-day nuclear deal negotiations.
- The IEA estimates in its latest Oil Market Report a Q2 deficit of 3.1mb/d, below our estimate of a 5.0mb/d deficit, given larger Q2 demand destruction of 5.5mb/d vs. GS at 4.9mb/d, peaking in May at 6.1mb/d (Exhibit 1).
 - Across products, IEA demand loss estimates are concentrated in petrochemical feedstocks, consistent with our analysis.
 - The IEA downgraded LPG and ethane demand by -1.7mb/d or -11% (vs. February expectations) and naphtha demand by -1.1mb/d or 15%.

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- Across regions, demand losses are the largest in Asia and Middle East, as the IEA downgraded China total oil demand by -2.2mb/d or -13%, Asia ex China by -1.5mb/d or -7%, and Middle East demand by -10%.
- The IEA revised up its Persian Gulf production losses, with total liquids production from Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and UAE declining in Q2 by 18.9mb/d from its February level.
 - The IEA keeps its assumption that Hormuz flows recovery starts in 2026Q3 and will take several months.
- The IEA also released their first 2027 balance and expects an average global surplus of 5.0mb/d (vs. GS at 3.2mb/d) on strong 7.9mb/d YoY supply growth and some lingering demand weakness.
- While China accounts for 40% of estimated global oil demand destruction at about 2mb/d, China crude imports dropped more sharply by 4.2mb/d YoY.
 - Taking into account recent China crude net imports, production, and crude throughput, we estimate crude stock draws at 1.6mb/d in May vs. 0.3mb/d draws in visible stocks ([Exhibit 2](#)).
 - This -1.3mb/d difference is likely driven by either meaningful invisible crude destocking (e.g. underground SPR) and/or even lower crude demand (lower refinery runs) than official data implies.
 - Lower China oil demand would be consistent with weaker China April-May economic activity and our estimates of a 23% year-over-year drop in China gasoline and other retail oil products sales volumes in May ([Exhibit 18](#)).

Charts of the Week

Exhibit 1: IEA Revises Down May World Oil Demand by 6.1mb/d in Latest Oil Market Report vs. the February Pre-War Estimates

IEA May Demand Forecast Revisions (June vs. February Oil Market Report), mb/d			
Total World Oil Demand		-6.1	
by Product		by Geography	
LPG and Ethane	-1.7	China	-2.2
Diesel and Gasoil	-1.2	Asia ex China	-1.5
Naphtha	-1.1	Middle East	-1.0
Motor Gasoline	-0.8	Europe	-0.8
Jet Fuel and Kerosene	-0.5	Rest of World	-0.6
		US	0.0

Source: IEA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: China Implied Estimated Stock Draws Exceeded Visible Draws by 1.3mb/d in May, Suggesting Either Meaningful Invisible Strategic Destocking or Lower Crude Demand (i.e. Lower Refinery Runs)

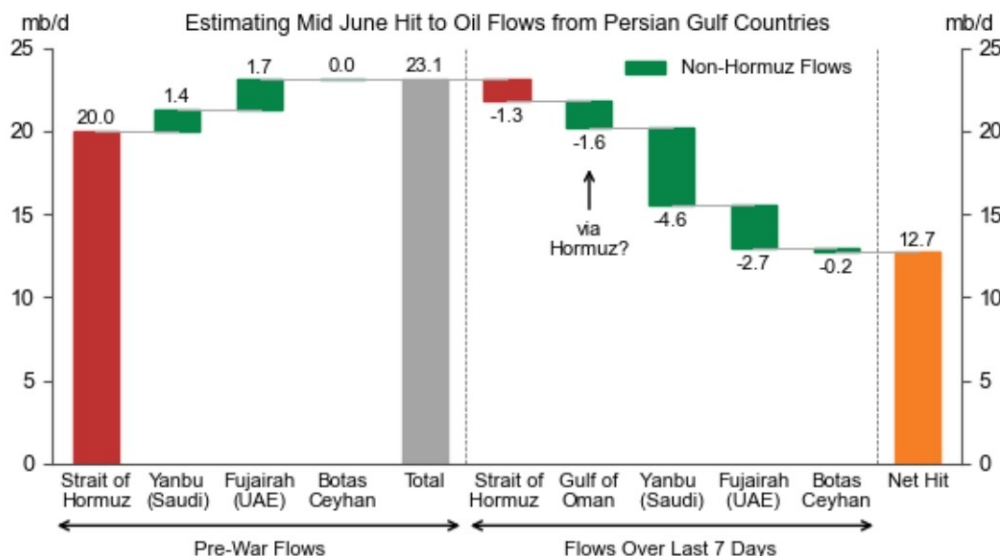
China Oil Balances, mb/d				
	May		May-March Average	
	Crude	Refined Products	Crude	Refined Products
1) Domestic Production	4.3	12.7	4.4	13.5
2) Net Imports	6.8	-0.1	8.4	0.0
3) Demand	12.7	12.5	13.5	12.9
4) Implied Change in Stocks: (1) + (2) - (3)	-1.6	0.2	-0.8	0.7
5) Visible Change in Stocks	-0.3	-0.1	0.2	0.1
Estimated Invisible Stock Changes: Implied Minus Visible Gap: (4) - (5)	-1.3	0.3	-1.0	0.6

We combine estimates of domestic production from the IEA, net imports and visible changes in stocks from Kpler and Oilchem, crude demand (i.e. refinery runs) from NBS, and refined products demand from S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Source: China National Bureau of Statistics, Kpler, S&P Global Market Intelligence, Oilchem, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

1) Persian Gulf Exports

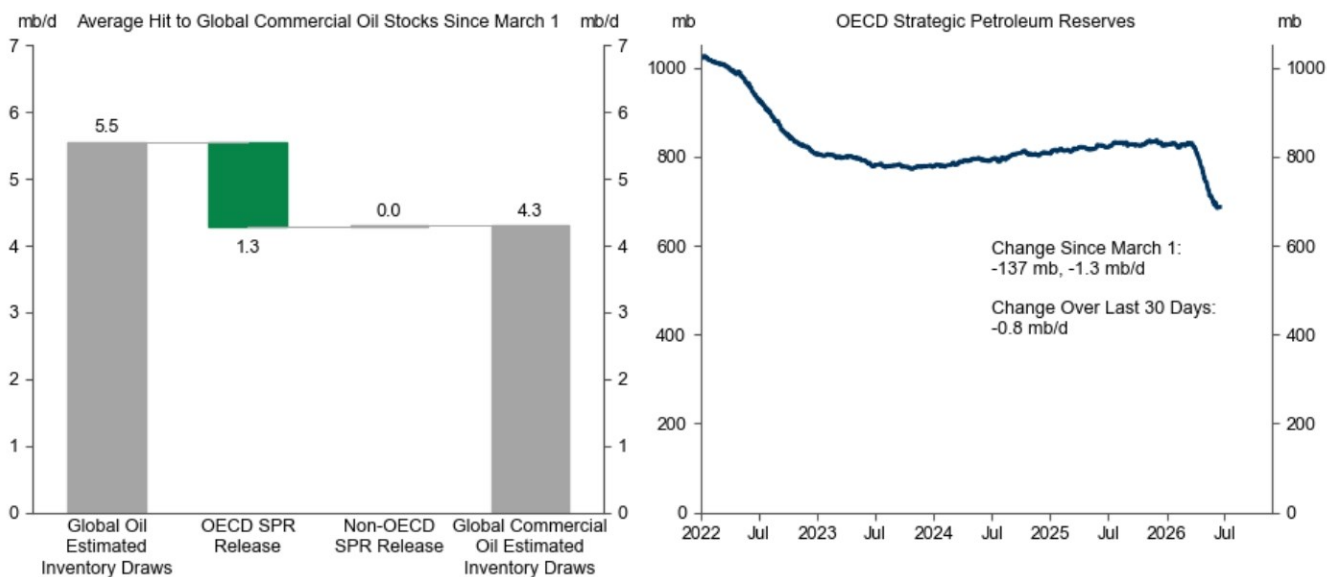
Exhibit 3: Normalization in Oil Exports From Gulf Producers to Their Pre-War Level May Be Achieved With a 12.7mb/d Increase in Hormuz Flows From Current Levels



Yanbu is on the west coast of Saudi Arabia, bordering the Red Sea and connected to Saudi eastern oil fields via the East-West pipeline. Fujairah lies east (outside) of the Strait of Hormuz and is connected to Abu Dhabi's onshore fields via the Abu Dhabi Crude Oil Pipeline (ADCOP). The Gulf of Oman connects the Strait to the Arabian Sea (southeast). The Kirkuk-Ceyhan pipeline allows northern Iraqi crude to be pumped through Turkey to the Mediterranean sea.

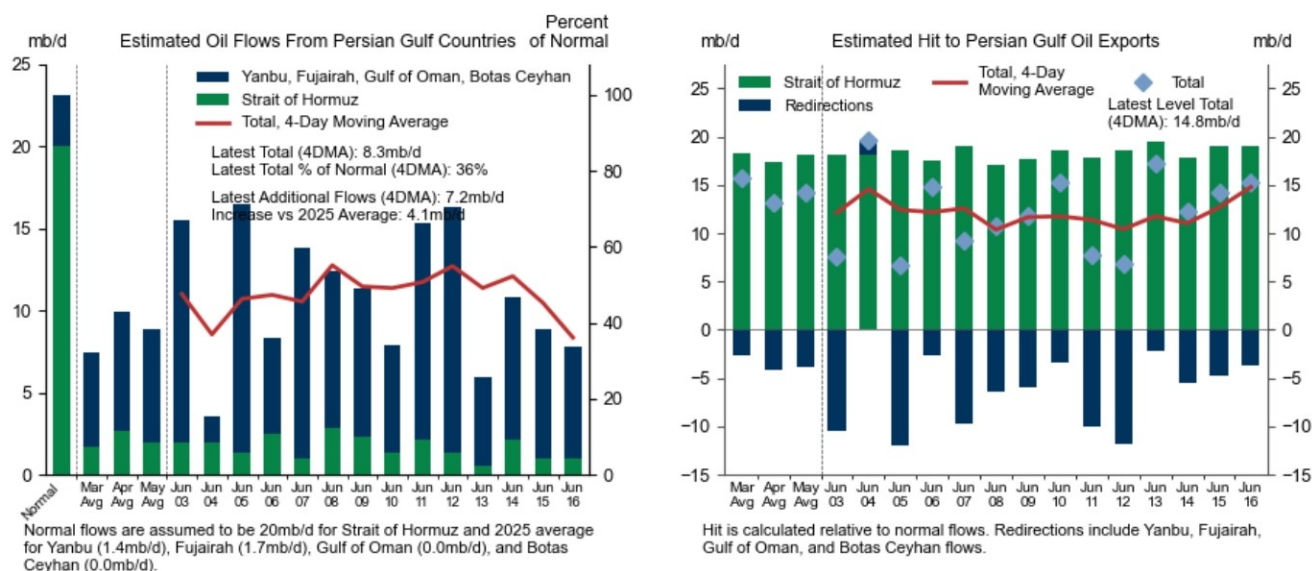
Source: Kpler, S&P Global Commodities at Sea, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: We Estimate That 1.3mb/d of Visible OECD SPR Releases Have Reduced the Estimated Hit to Global Commercial Oil Stocks Since March by 1.3mb/d to 4.3mb/d

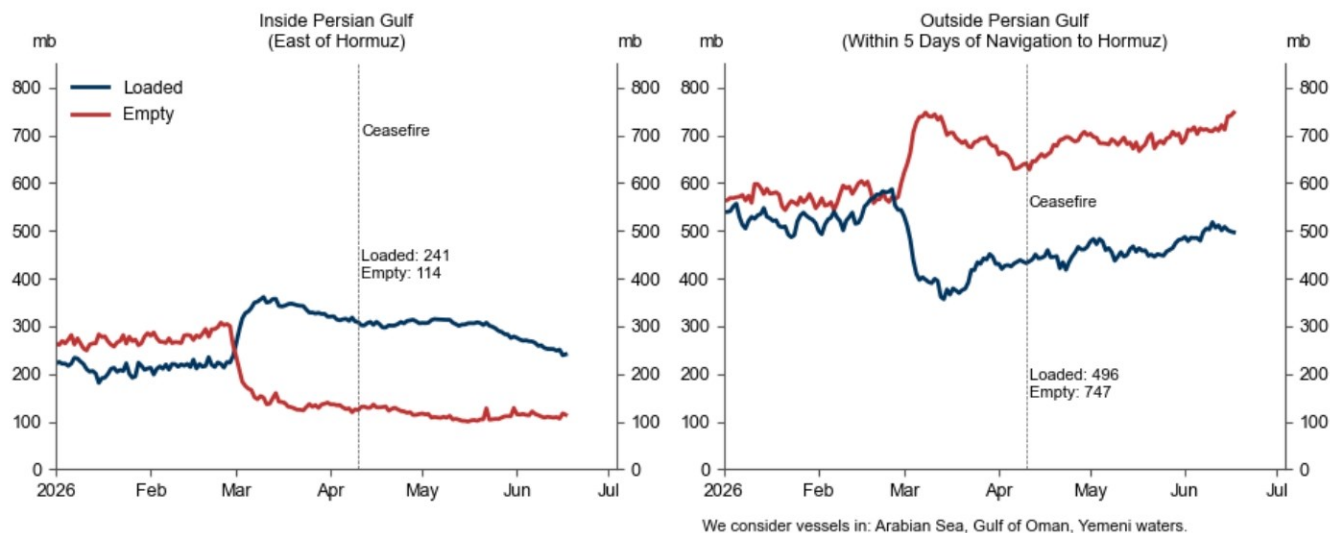


We estimate global oil inventory draws from latest GS oil balance.

Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: The Estimated Total Hit to Oil Flows from the Persian Gulf Is Currently at 14.8mb/d (4-Day Moving Average)


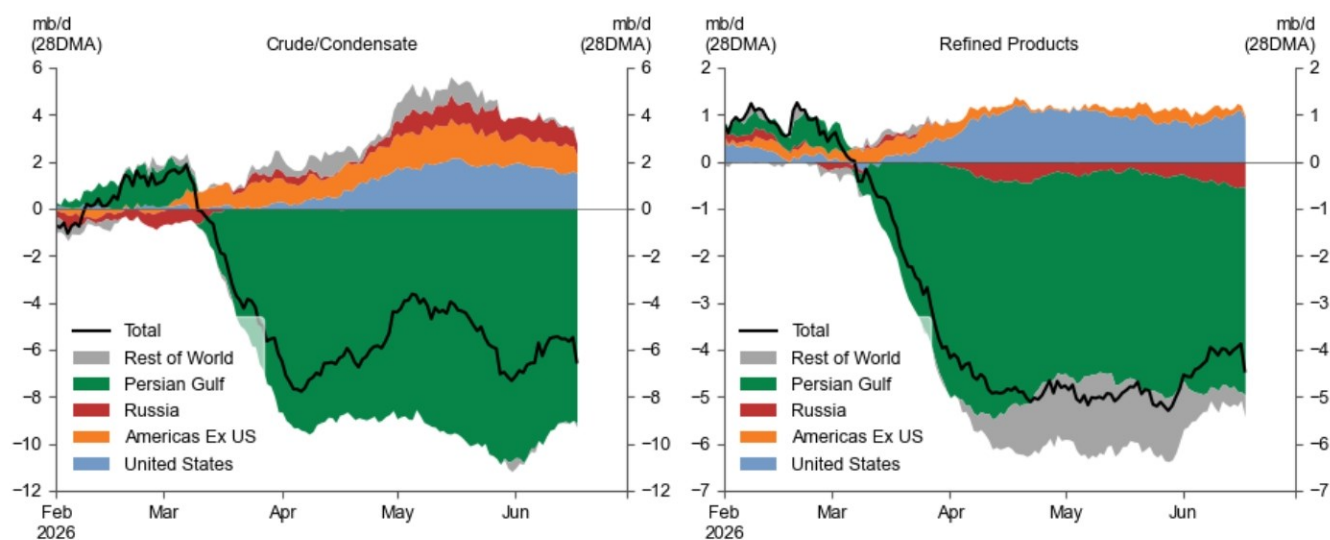
Source: S&P Global Commodities at Sea, Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: We Estimate That Empty Oil Tankers Within the Strait or Within 5 Days of Navigation Have the Capacity to Load 861 Million Barrels
Oil Tanker Capacity on Both Sides of Hormuz


Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: 28% of the Hit to Persian Gulf Crude/Condensate Exports Is Currently Being Offset, With Contributions From Higher Exports from the US/Americas Ex US/Russia of 16pp/8pp/5pp

Global Oil Exports vs. 2025 Average

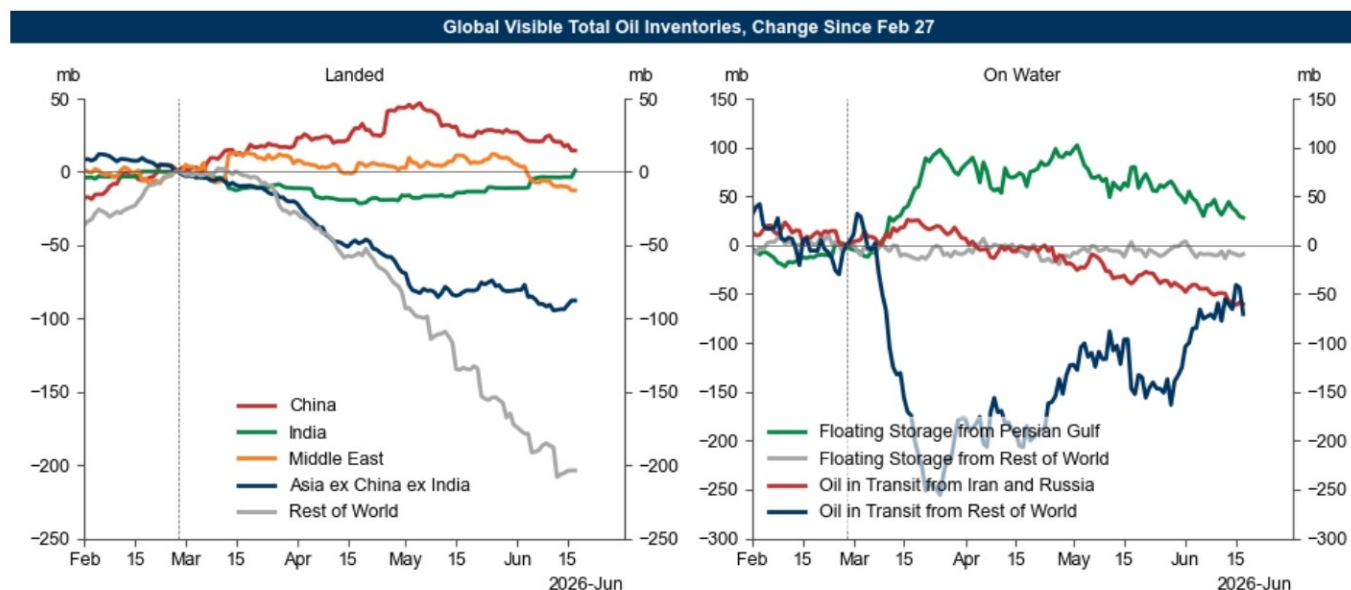


Refined products include LPG.

Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

2) Inventories

Exhibit 8: China Landed Visible Inventories Have Drawn by 0.5mb/d Over the Last 14 Days



Source: IEA, Kpler, DOE, Euroilstocks, ARA PJK, PAJ, Haver, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: Global Visible Draws Have Averaged at 3.4mb/d Since March 1st

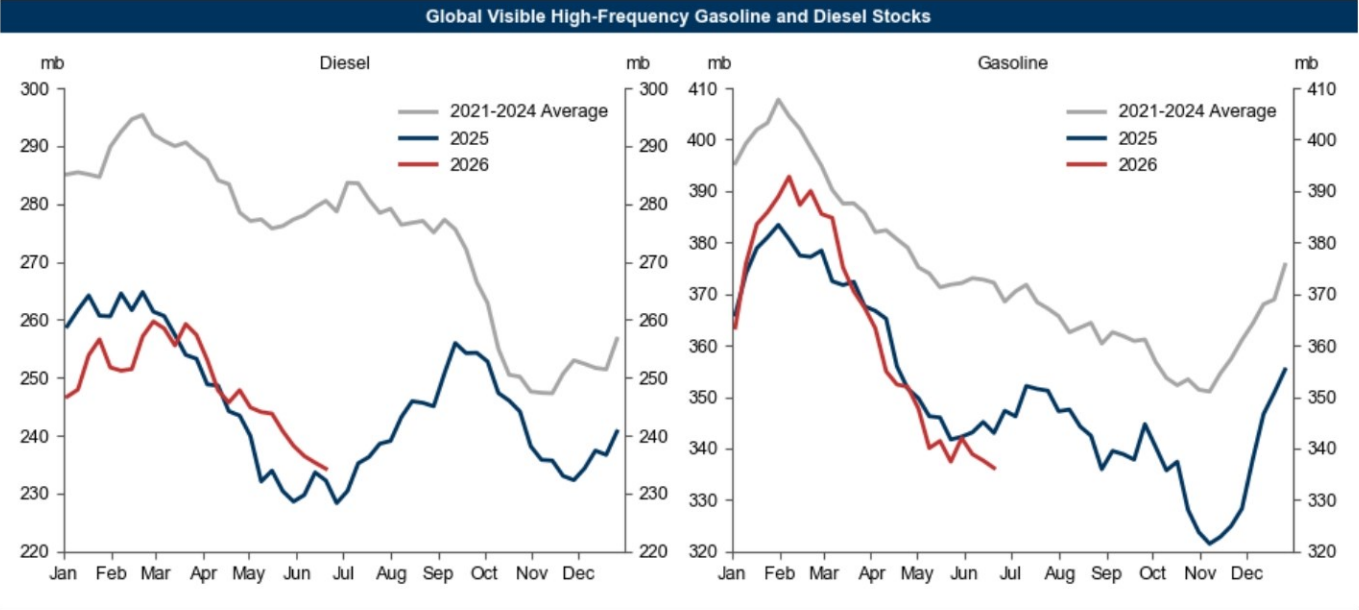
Visible Oil Stocks, Month-Over-Month Changes (mb/d)				
	June	May	April	Average Since March 1st
Global Visible Stocks	-2.2	-5.5	-2.0	-3.4
Landed Crude Stocks	-2.0	-2.9	-2.2	-2.5
OECD	-1.1	-2.7	-2.6	-2.3
China	-0.5	-0.3	0.4	-0.1
Non-OECD Ex China	-0.4	0.1	0.0	0.0
Landed Products Stocks	-0.6	-0.7	-1.1	-0.8
OECD NGL	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2
OECD Refined Products	0.1	-0.5	-1.4	-0.7
Non-OECD Total Products	-0.8	-0.3	0.1	-0.3
Oil on Water	0.5	-1.9	1.3	-0.1
Floating Crude	-0.7	-1.0	0.4	-0.4
Floating Products	-0.6	0.0	0.0	-0.1
Crude in Transit	2.4	-0.5	1.3	0.9
Products in Transit	-0.6	-0.4	-0.4	-0.5

Latest observation is today, and data is unsmoothed. "Crude" categories (landed and on water) include both crude and condensate. Month-over-month changes are calculated by taking the end-of-month level (or latest realized level, if the month isn't yet over), subtracting the previous month's end-of-month level, and dividing by the number of days.

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Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

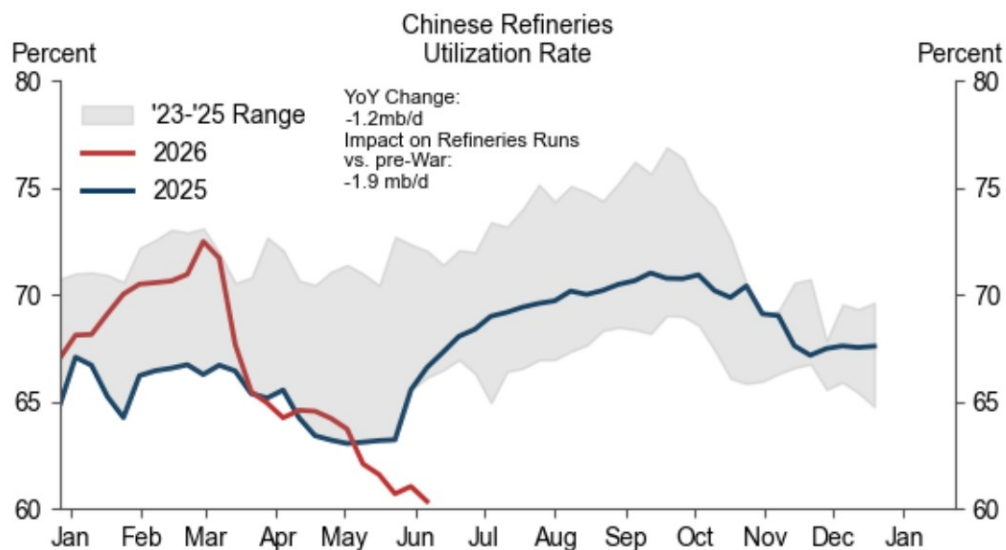
Exhibit 10: Global Diesel and Gasoline High-Frequency Visible Stocks Decreased to the Bottom of Their Seasonal Range



Source: DOE, Longzhong, ARA PJK, Fujairah, Singapore Enterprise, IEA, PAJ, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

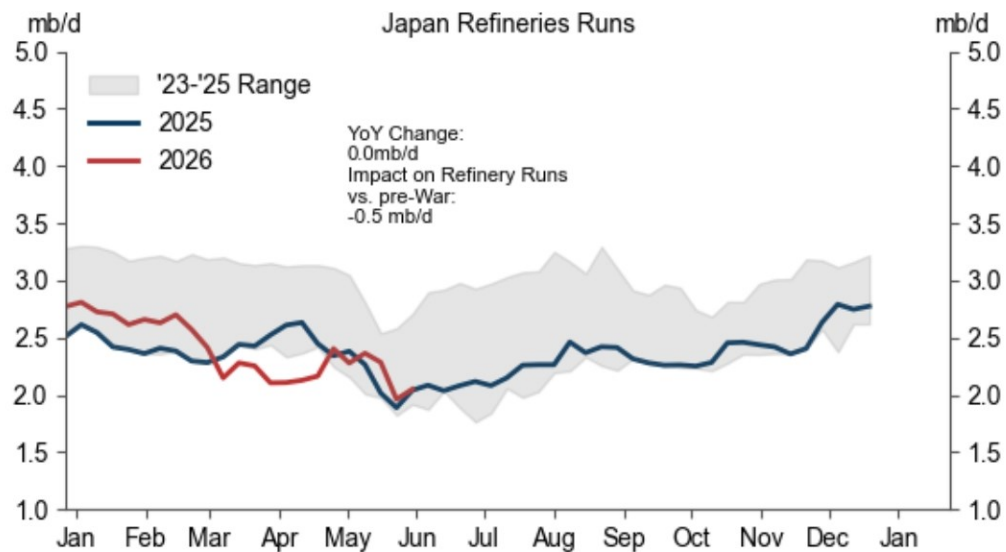
3) Refining

Exhibit 11: Estimated Chinese Refineries Runs Have Declined by 1.9mb/d Since End of February



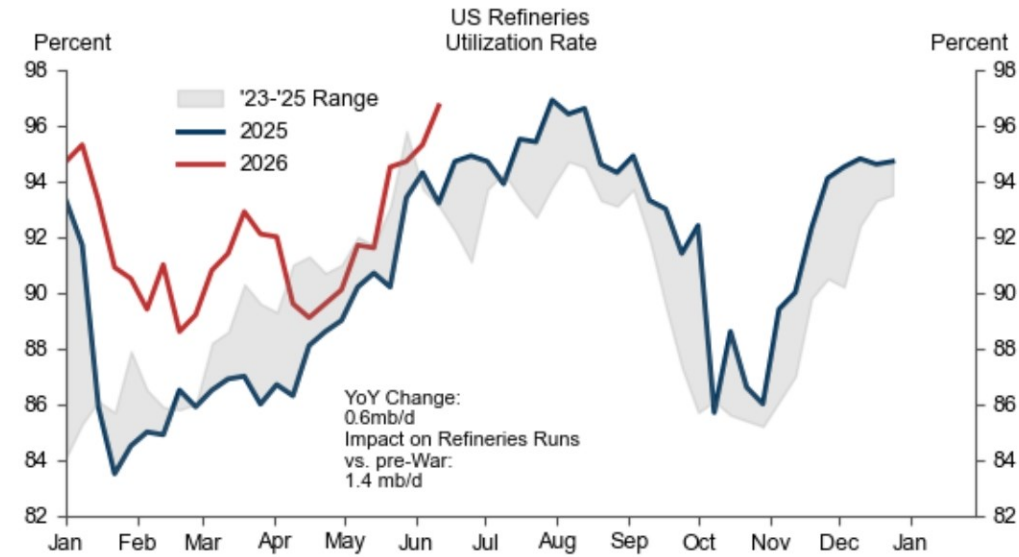
Source: Oilchem, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: Japanese Refineries Runs Are 0.5mb/d Lower Than Their End-of-February Levels



Source: PAJ, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: The Utilization Rate of US Refineries Is Up 0.6pp Year-Over-Year as US Product Margins Remain High

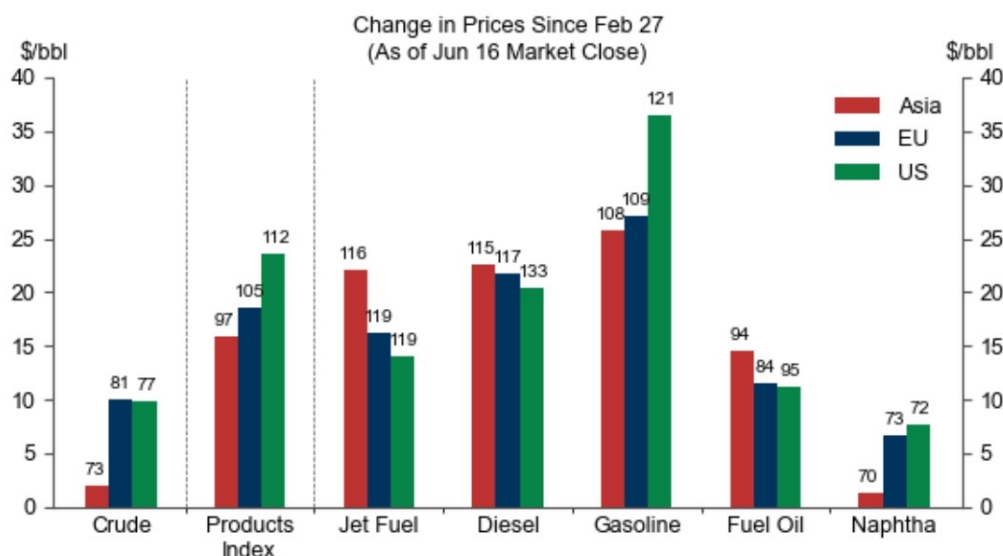


Source: EIA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

4) Energy Prices

Energy Prices Across Regions

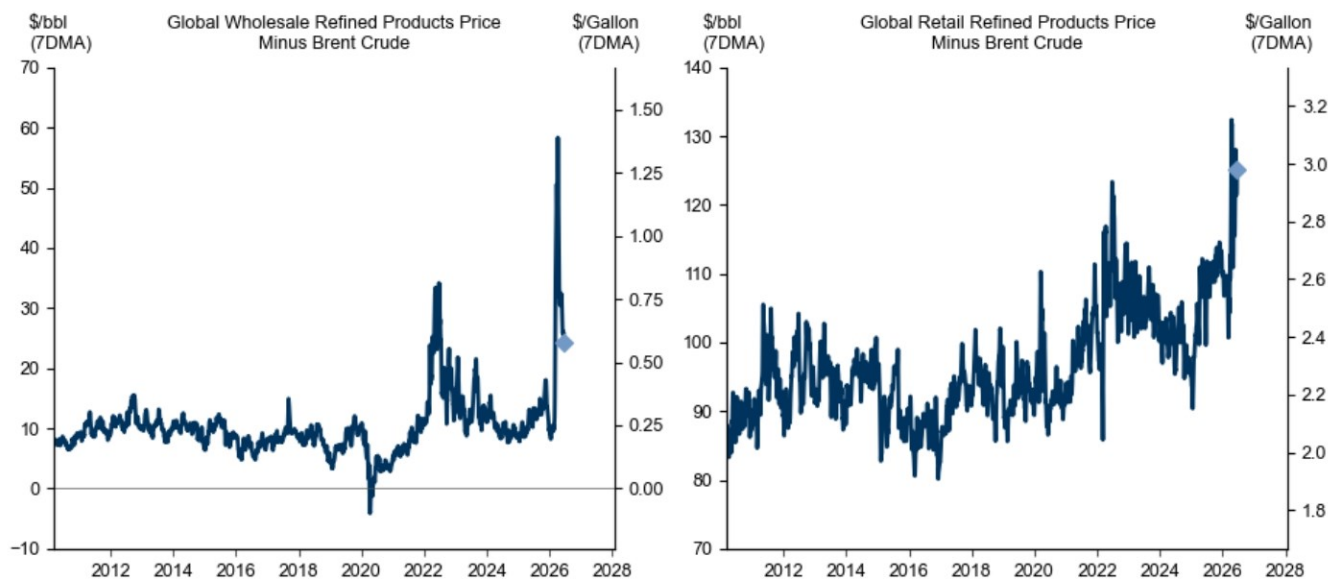
Exhibit 14: US Wholesale Gasoline Prices Outperform Regional Counterparts and Products Across the Barrel on Strong Summer Demand



Bar labels indicate crude/refined products prices as of June 16th market close. We consider cash or cash-equivalent prices.

Source: ICE, Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: While Global Wholesale Refined Products Prices Continue to Normalize, Retail Prices Remain Elevated

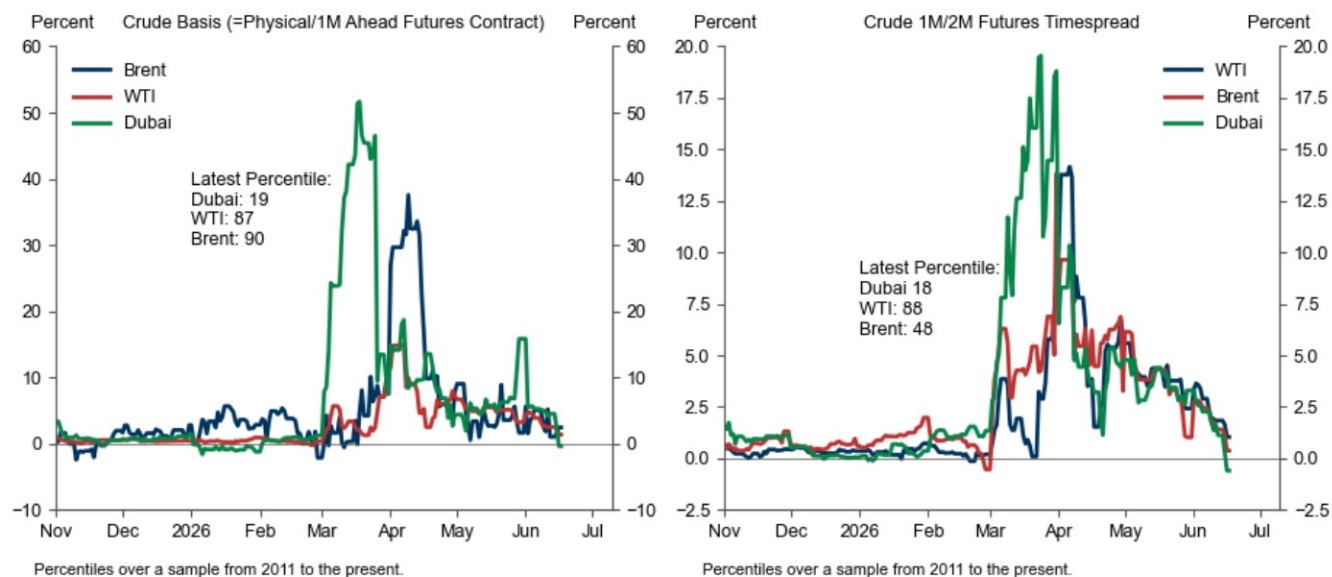


The global retail refined product price is a simple average of global retail gasoline and diesel price indices, which are each demand-weighted averages of 40 country-level retail product prices. The global wholesale refined product price is a demand-weighted average of wholesale price indices in the US, Europe, and Asia, which are themselves demand-weighted averages of gasoline, diesel, jet fuel, naphtha, and fuel oil prices.

Source: Platts, EIA, Government Sources, ICE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Crude Prices

Exhibit 16: Dubai Prompt Timespreads Fall in Contango Potentially Reflecting Rising Crude Exports From the Gulf, the Expectation of Hormuz Reopening, and Weak China Crude Imports

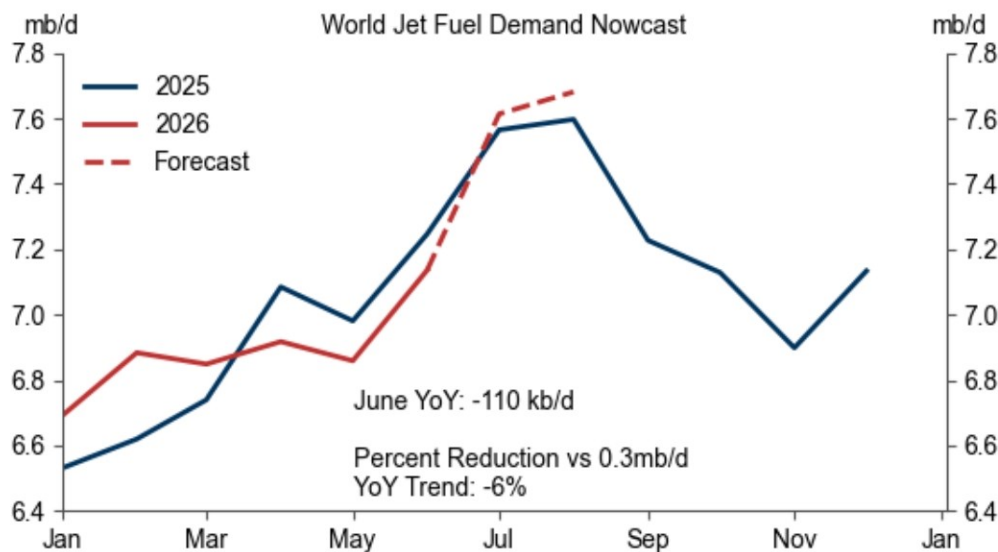


Basis represents the difference (in % of 1M ahead futures) between spot physical crude futures and 1M ahead financial futures. We include Brent, Dubai, and WTI in crude basis on the left panel and in 1M/2M timespreads on the right panel.

Source: Platts, CME, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

5) Demand

Exhibit 17: We Estimate That Global Jet Fuel Demand in June Will be 110kb/d Softer Year-Over-Year, or 6% Below Trend

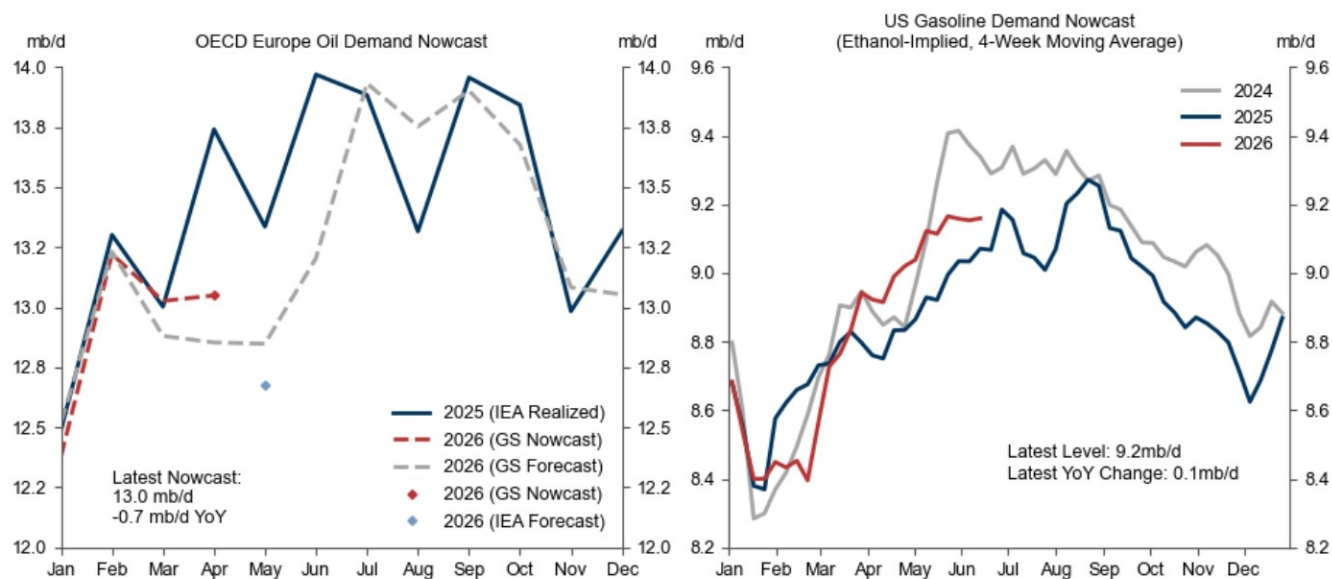


Source: EIA, OAG, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

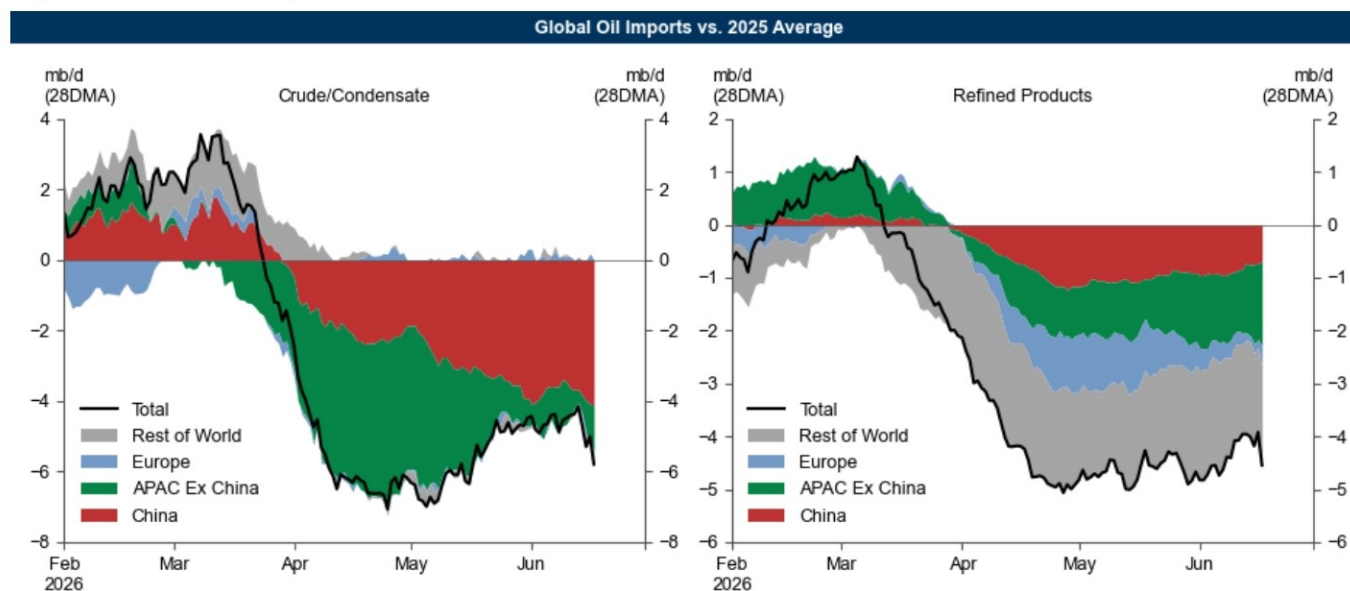
Exhibit 18: China and European Road Fuels Retail Sales Decreased by 23.3% and 3.5% Respectively From Year-Ago Levels



Source: NBS, Statistical Office of the European Communities, Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: Our US Gasoline Demand Nowcast Is Slightly Above Its Last Year Seasonal Levels


Source: IEA, S&P, Kpler, GTT, Oilchem, MySteel, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 20: Global Crude/Condensate Imports Are Down 5.8mb/d from 2025 Average Levels, and Refined Products Imports Are Down 4.5mb/d


Refined products include LPG.

Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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